FACELESS48 · LESSON 9

Stock footage

Optional free B-roll from Pexels and Pixabay, with your own keys. You choose every clip.

> Everything in the plug-in works without stock footage. If you want B-roll to cut away to, here is how to add it.

Words in bold are what you say to your assistant.

What a key is

A key is like a library card. It lets the plug-in search for you. Keys are free and take about five minutes each. They stay on your computer. You can use just one provider.

1. Pexels key

Go to **pexels.com/api** and sign in. Click Your API Key and fill in the short form. The app name can be anything, like My video projects. Copy the key.

2. Pixabay key

Go to **pixabay.com/api/docs** and sign in. Scroll to Parameters. Your key is shown next to the word key. Copy it.

3. Where the keys go

In your project folder there is a file called stock-keys.example.json. Copy it and name the copy **stock-keys.json**. Paste each key between the quotes and save.

Then say: **Check my stock keys.** It tells you set or not set for each. It never prints your keys back.

Never paste your keys into chat, an email or a shared document. If you think one got out, make a new one on the website.

If your assistant runs in the cloud, set the keys as environment secrets instead of a file and allow api.pexels.com, videos.pexels.com, images.pexels.com, pixabay.com and cdn.pixabay.com.

4. Find footage

Say: **Find stock footage for this video.** It reads your script and turns each shot into a search phrase of two to four concrete words: what is in the frame, not the idea. Woman typing laptop night, not productivity.

5. You choose

It searches both sites and shows the options with where each is from, how long it is, who made it and a link to the clip's page, plus preview images. Open the links to watch the clips. You choose the ones you like.

6. Download and place

Only then does it download, one clip per choice. Each clip is saved into your project and its source and creator are recorded. A clip you choose can fade in as a cutaway over your talking-head video, move, and fade back to you, while your voice keeps playing.

7. Credits

When your video is done, say **Show me my stock credits.** It gives you a credit line for each clip, ready to paste into your caption or description.

Rules to know

Pixabay results are kept for 24 hours, so the same search within a day does not hit their service again. Clips are downloaded before use, never streamed from the site. The tool never bulk-downloads.

Both sites' licenses allow free use in videos, with limits. For anything sensitive, like an ad with a recognizable person or brand, read the license page yourself and check it again before you publish commercially.

If you see too many requests, wait a little and try again. If a portrait search hides some results, the tool tells you and you can ask to see everything.

Before you move on

- ☐ I made a Pexels or Pixabay key.
- ☐ I put my key in stock-keys.json and ran Check my stock keys.
- ☐ I searched, looked at the previews and chose a clip.
- ☐ I saved my stock credits for my caption.

Stuck? Email support@c3global.co with what you asked and the exact error. Never include passwords or API keys.